

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: From Farid to Sher Shah

FARID -> Sur family/Sasaram lands + Bihar service and revenue experience

SHER KHAN TITLE -> heroic/tiger tradition is source-mediated

BIHAR -> chiefs + estates + forts + local knowledge

SURAJGARH 1534 -> Bengal victory expands prestige/resources

GAUR/BENGAL -> larger fiscal-military base

CHAUSA 1539 + KANNAUJ 1540 -> sovereignty, bounded to Topic 13

VERDICT: opportunity converted by coalition/state-building, not instant genius.

MUST REMEMBER: Sher Shah's reign (1540-45) linked conquest to sarkar-pargana administration, revenue, roads, sarais and currency.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Sur chronology c.1510-1555

c.1510 -> Farid gains pargana-level experience

1534 -> Surajgarh | 1537 -> Gaur captured by Sher Khan's side

1539 -> Chausa | 1540 -> Kannauj and formal sovereignty

1542 -> Malwa | 1543-44 -> Multan, upper Sindh and Rajasthan fields

1544 -> Samel | May 1545 -> death during Kalinjar siege

1545-53 -> Islam Shah | 1555 -> Humayun returns after fragmentation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Bihar-Bengal scale-up to sovereignty

LOCAL BASE -> land knowledge + Afghan followers + forts + revenue

BENGAL CONTEST -> Surajgarh and Gaur enlarge resources and reputation

ROUTE CONTROL -> Gangetic communications expose Humayun's eastern campaign

MILITARY VICTORY -> Chausa and Kannauj redistribute forts and elite loyalty

POLITICAL TASK -> battlefield success must become collection and enforcement

OUTCOME: Sher Khan becomes Sher Shah by converting scale into sovereignty.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Empire and campaign fields

CORE -> Delhi-Agra-Ganga + Bihar-Bengal administration/routes

NORTH-WEST -> Lahore/Multan/Indus + Rohtas frontier

CENTRAL/WEST -> Malwa 1542 + Raisen 1543 + Sammel 1544

BUNDELKHAND -> Kalinjar siege/death 1545

MAP CODES -> direct core | garrison/route | tributary ruler | campaign reach

SOURCES -> numbers, Puran Mal safe-conduct and forged letters cautioned

RULE: one colour cannot represent all Sur control.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Afghan monarchy and personal supervision

SULTAN -> strong personal monarchy + court/central departments

NOBLES/CLANS -> honour + service + assignments + bargaining

SARKAR/SHIQ -> military-police and revenue/judicial supervision

PARGANA -> shiqdar + amin/munsif + qanungo + fotedar + writers

VILLAGE -> muqaddam + patwari + panchayat + zamindar + cultivator

ISLAM SHAH -> continuity plus tighter noble/camp discipline

CAUTION: neither tribal democracy nor modern bureaucracy.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Territory and mediated countryside

SOVEREIGN CENTRE

- > SARKAR / SHIQ: territorial command and overlapping officials
- > PARGANA: assessment, records, policing and local information
- > VILLAGE: cultivators, muqaddams and other intermediaries

ZAMINDARS -> controlled, punished or negotiated with; not abolished

TRAP: this was neither Akbar's mature suba system nor modern ryotwari.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Revenue measurement and record chain

MEASURE -> jarib/bigha and Sikandari-gaz tradition

CLASSIFY -> good + middling + bad; ideal account

RAI -> crop yield/price schedule -> qualified one-third demand norm

PATTA -> written state demand | QABULIYAT -> cultivator acceptance

COLLECT -> cash/kind through officials + zamindars/headmen

LIMIT -> Multan/frontier/crop/soil/price and Sarwani idealization

RULE: regularization was not universal measurement or ryotwari.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Road-sarai-customs-dak circulation system

OLD CORRIDORS -> repair + extension + policing, not road invention
SONARGAON-INDUS | AGRA-BURHANPUR | AGRA-RAJASTHAN | LAHORE-MULTAN
SARAI -> lodging + animals + food + market + official/security node
WATER/TREES/BRIDGE-FERRY -> route support varied by place
DAK/NEWS -> horses/runners/intelligence, not modern postal department
CUSTOMS -> controlled entry/sale ideal; implementation uneven
OUTCOME -> trade + tax + army + surveillance in one circulation system.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Money, order and military controls

COIN -> standardized gold + silver rupiya + copper dam through mints

CAUTION -> earlier silver/rupee existed; standardization, not invention

ARMY -> direct recruitment + cash/assignments + cavalry/artillery/forts

DAGH/CHEHRA -> Alauddin precedent; Sur enforcement is chronicle-mediated

POLICING -> local responsibility + patrols + severe punishment

JUSTICE STORIES -> impartiality ideal, not crime statistics

ROHTAS != ROHTASGARH -> north-west frontier versus Bihar fort.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Forts, religion and succession limits

RAISEN/PURAN MAL -> surrender/violence/legitimacy source problem

RELIGION -> Sunni legitimacy + diverse officials/subjects + coercive episodes

SASARAM -> octagonal lake tomb across Sher/Islam Shah phases

PURANA QILA/QILA-I-KUHNA -> multi-phase Delhi landscape

1545 KALINJAR -> gunpowder accident/death

1553+ -> Firuz killed; Adil/Sikandar/Ibrahim + Hemu + civil wars

VERDICT: personal control and succession faction, not inherent Afghan incapacity.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Patta-qabuliyat and measurement claims need source-aware wording rather than projection of later uniform practice.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Continuity, source method and Akbar

SULTANATE -> sarkar/pargana + measurement + roads + coin + dagh/chehra

SUR -> systematize, connect and supervise under short-reign conditions

AKBAR -> selects/adapts at larger scale with subas/mansab/zabt-dahsala

SOURCES -> Sarwani ideal + Nizamuddin/Mughal retrospective

CHECK -> coins + inscriptions + Sasaram/Purana Qila/Rohtas fabric

COLONIAL MEMORY -> GT Road/modern-administrator labels can exaggerate invention

RULE: continuity and modification, never a finished copied blueprint.

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Calling Sher Shah a Mughal precursor is useful only when institutional continuity and later adaptation are qualified.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Topic 14 answer spine

SOURCE -> Sarwani claim + date/purpose + coin/fabric/institutional check

MAP -> core + routes/forts + tribute/frontier + campaign reach

STATE -> Afghan monarchy + nobles + sarkar/pargana/village mediation

SYSTEM -> revenue + roads/sarais + money + army + justice/trade

LIMIT -> region + intermediaries + coercion + short reign + evidence

SUCCESSION -> Islam Shah -> civil wars/Hemu -> Humayun 1555

VERDICT -> strong state-builder/systematizer, not modern inventor or Akbar blueprint.